



GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT

OFFICIAL MINUTES — WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

The Grimes County Commissioners Court met on Wednesday, September 9, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

Call to Order

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. on Wednesday, September 9, 2026, in Commissioners Court at 270 FM 149 West Anderson, Texas, noting that notice of the regular meeting had been posted in accordance with statute and that all court members were in attendance.

Public Comments

We look forward to hearing from the citizens of Grimes County. If you wish to make public comments you will need to submit a Public Participation Form prior to the start of the meeting and give it to the County Clerk. Public comments will be limited to 2 minutes per person.

The Judge announced that public comments would be limited to two minutes per person and that two submissions had been received. Identifying herself as Debra Morwood from Lola, spoke in strong support of adding staff to the road and bridge development services, including a development technician and administrative position. She emphasized that the permitting, inspections, and enforcement functions of the development services department were critical tools for protecting existing residents, businesses, and infrastructure as the county experienced growth, and urged the court to approve the additional positions and resources requested. Marie Egyed, representing Grimes County Citizens for Responsible Development and a resident of Lola, raised concerns about transparency in the budget process, noting that the proposed budget available to the public had not matched the version being discussed by the court and that revisions had not been reposted with adequate notice. She referenced changes to Texas law effective September 1, 2025, requiring that proposed budgets be included with meeting notice or clearly available from the website homepage, and requested that supporting documents for significant agenda items be made available with sufficient time for public review.

Consent Agenda Items

1. Consider and take action to approve Budget Amendments and/or Line-Item Transfers.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Chad Mallett to Approve consent agenda budget line-item transfers with the requested amendment decreasing account 001-0437-4404 by \$151.86 and increasing account 001-0437-4483 by \$151.86. Seconded by Commissioner Michael Raska. Carried (5-0-0).

Discuss and take action on awarding contract to vendors for RFP 26-4081 Fire Plan Examination and Inspector. — Dione Bumpous, Grimes County EMC/Fire Marshal

EMC/Fire Marshal Dione Bumpous presented a request to award contracts under RFP 26-4081 for fire plan examination and inspector services. The county had issued a request for proposals to develop a

rotating vendor list that could assist with fire inspections and plant examinations on projects too large for the county office to handle independently. Two proposals were received from Leaf Inc. in Weldon. County Attorney Megan Barcak stated she had not yet completed her full review of the contracts but indicated that she had drafted them with only minor modifications based on the RFP requirements and expected them to be acceptable pending her final review. EMC/Fire Marshal Bumpous requested permission to extend contracts to both vendors subject to the county attorney's final approval.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Chad Mallett to Award RFP 26-4081 Fire Plan Examination and Inspector contract to both submitting vendors (Leaf Inc. and Weldon), subject to final review and approval by the County Attorney. Seconded by County Judge Joe Fauth. Carried (5-0-0).

Consider and take action to approve the 5 year contract with CapRisk Consulting Group for OPEB Actuarial Valuations. — Jessi Murphy, Grimes County Auditor

County Judge Joe Fauth stated that there was a request by the County Auditor, Ms Murphy to table this item today and move it to the September 16, 2026 Agenda. Judge Fauth granted her request.

Action: Motion by County Judge Joe Fauth to Table consideration of the 5-year contract with CapRisk Consulting Group for OPEB Actuarial Valuations and continue to the September 16 agenda. Tabled.

Consider and take action regarding the Burn Ban and authorize the County Judge as signatory. — Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

Current Burn Ban ordered August 19, 2026, expiring November 17, 2026.

County Judge Joe Fauth asked EMC/Fire Marshal Dione Bumpous about the status of the burn ban, which was ordered August 19, 2026, and expires November 17, 2026. EMC/Fire Marshal Dione Bumpous reported that despite recent showers throughout the county, the drought index remained at 685, which is higher than when the ban was placed, indicating continued high risk and low moisture conditions. EMC/Fire Marshal Dione Bumpous recommended no action at this time, and County Judge Joe Fauth indicated the court's approval of that recommendation.

Action: No action.

Discuss and take action on any issue regarding FY 27 Proposed Budget. — Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

County Judge Joe Fauth opened discussion of the FY 2027 proposed budget and asked County Auditor Jessi Murphy to identify any items requiring particular attention. County Auditor Murphy directed the court to Fund 45 on page 52, noting that the Law Enforcement Officers line for the sheriff's office had been reduced from \$15,000 to \$13,007.48 due to remaining reserves, though she noted the court could budget the full \$15,000 if it preferred to transfer from general funds. She also flagged a line item on page 13 that currently budgeted at \$51,400 would need to be increased to \$56,050 to cover contracts in place, explaining that a single audit threshold would be met this year necessitating the increase. County Auditor Murphy reported that revenues had been reassessed overall, and she directed attention to page 56, line 4274505 for machinery and equipment, where the department head had requested an increase to \$15,000 for contracted elections, though that line was currently zero. County Judge Fauth requested an adjustment to the postage line on page 6, noting that individual grievance committee mail packets had increased to \$21 each for registered mail, and he asked that the commissioners and auditor increase that line by \$210 to cover ten packets, raising the total from \$150 to \$360. The discussion then turned to the chaplain position for the jail, with Commissioner Phillip Cox noting it should be included. County Judge Fauth proposed budgeting it as a temporary position at \$15 per hour for eight hours per week (416 total hours annually) to test the arrangement before potentially converting it to part-time status in the following year. County Auditor Jessi Murphy noted the position would cost approximately \$9,000 to \$10,000 depending on classification. The court discussed at length

the appropriate pay classification for deputy constables compared to sheriff's deputies under Option One versus Option Two of the proposed pay scale, technical updates to the sheriff's office salary sheet provided late in the process, the appropriate minimum wage floor across county positions, and funding allocations toward jail infrastructure planning. Commissioner Chad Mallett proposed keeping deputy constables at the current minimum salary until a comprehensive salary study could be completed in the following year, while Commissioner David Tullos argued for bringing deputy constables to the same pay scale as sheriff's deputies to address pay inequity among law enforcement officers doing similar work. Precinct 1 Constable James Ellis and Blake Jarvis, Pct 2, representing the constable's precincts, testified that constables perform the same law enforcement duties and face the same risks as sheriff's deputies and urged pay parity; County Auditor Murphy and Human Resource Director Atina Adair provided technical salary information showing an \$83 annual difference at the minimum level and explaining the impact of Senate Bill 22 funding on the sheriff's office but not the constables' budget. County Judge Fauth ultimately indicated that the proposed budget should include option one, which brings both deputy constables and sheriff's deputies to the midpoint salary, and instructed the auditor to incorporate this decision along with all other discussed adjustments into a revised budget to be presented at the following week's meeting.

ADJOURN

Motion by Commissioner Michael Raska to Adjourn the meeting. Seconded by Commissioner Chad Mallett. Carried (5–0–0). The meeting adjourned at 10:56 AM.

THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT ON September 9th, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.

County Clerk Barbara Kimich